MODULE 07 · FOUNDATIONS

Digital Literacy & Internet Safety

A Custom AI-Generated Companion Guide

The foundational skills to use the internet confidently, critically, and safely.

DIGITAL GIRLS INITIATIVE PAKISTAN
Empowering young women through free tech education

3–4 weeks · 2–3 hrs/week

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Welcome & How to Use This Guide

Before writing a line of code or opening a design tool, everyone benefits from a strong foundation in how to actually use the internet well — finding trustworthy information, protecting personal data, and communicating responsibly online. This track is a great starting point for absolute beginners, and a useful refresher for everyone else.

> **Mentor Tip**
> Treat this module as a warm-up — it's short, but the habits you build here protect every other skill you learn after it.

Estimated time: 3–4 weeks · 2–3 hrs/week · Level: No experience needed — a great first module

01 Digital Foundations

Confidence with devices and files

Comfortable, everyday use of a computer or phone is the base every other skill in this program is built on.

01 Operating a device confidently
Files, folders, settings, and installing software safely.

02 File management
Organizing, naming, and backing up your work so nothing gets lost.

03 Email essentials
Writing clear, professional emails and managing an inbox.

04 Cloud tools
Google Docs, Drive, and other tools for working and collaborating online.

★ Practice Project

Organize a personal folder system for your schoolwork or projects, with backups set up in the cloud.

02 Navigating the Internet

Finding information you can trust

Search engines return millions of results instantly — the real skill is judging which of them are actually reliable.

01 Effective searching
Using search operators and specific keywords to find what you actually need.

02 Evaluating sources
Checking who wrote something, when, and why, before trusting it.

03 Spotting misinformation
Common patterns behind fake news and manipulated media.

04 Understanding your digital footprint
What you post and search leaves a trail — understanding what that means.

★ Practice Project

Fact-check three viral claims you've seen online using at least two independent sources each.

03 Staying Safe Online

Protecting yourself and your information

This phase is about building safety habits that protect you without limiting how you use the internet.

01 Privacy settings
Locking down what strangers can see on your social accounts.

02 Recognizing scams
Common tricks used to steal money or information from young people specifically.

03 Safe social media use
What's safe to share publicly, and what never is.

04 Protecting personal information
Understanding what data apps collect, and how to limit it.

★ Practice Project

Run a privacy check-up across your three most-used apps and tighten every setting that overshares.

04 Digital Citizenship

Being a good, capable presence online

The internet is a shared space — this final phase covers using it well, for yourself and for others.

01 Respectful communication
Disagreeing and engaging online without it turning toxic.

02 Healthy screen time habits
Noticing and managing how technology affects your focus and mood.

03 Using tech for opportunity
Free courses, scholarships, and communities available to anyone online.

04 Helping others
Sharing what you've learned with family members newer to the internet.

★ Practice Project

Teach one family member or friend three safety habits from this module, in your own words.

Free Video Courses

Curated, highly-rated, and completely free. Pick whichever teaching style fits you best.

> **Google Applied Digital Skills**
> Free, guided lessons on practical digital skills
> *https://applieddigitalskills.withgoogle.com/*

> **GCFGlobal.org — Digital Literacy Lessons**
> Simple, well-structured free lessons for every level
> *https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/*

> **Common Sense Education**
> Trusted, youth-focused digital citizenship resources
> *https://www.commonsense.org/education*

> **Google Digital Garage**
> Free foundational courses on digital skills and safety
> *https://learndigital.withgoogle.com/digitalgarage*

Your Practice Checklist

Print this page or copy it into a notebook. Check off each project as you finish it — real, working projects are what turn this guide into a portfolio.

- [ ] **Phase 01: Digital Foundations — Organize a personal folder system for your schoolwork or projects, wi**
- [ ] **Phase 02: Navigating the Internet — Fact-check three viral claims you've seen online using at least two**
- [ ] **Phase 03: Staying Safe Online — Run a privacy check-up across your three most-used apps and tighter**
- [ ] **Phase 04: Digital Citizenship — Teach one family member or friend three safety habits from this module**

Finished all four phases?

Bring your projects to a DG·IP mentor session — we review portfolios and help you plan your next module.

You've got the roadmap.
Now go build something.

This guide is one part of the free DG·IP curriculum. Come back to the website for the live version of this module, curated videos, and seven other free skill tracks.

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